

# SUPINE TWIST

*Supta Matsyendrasana*

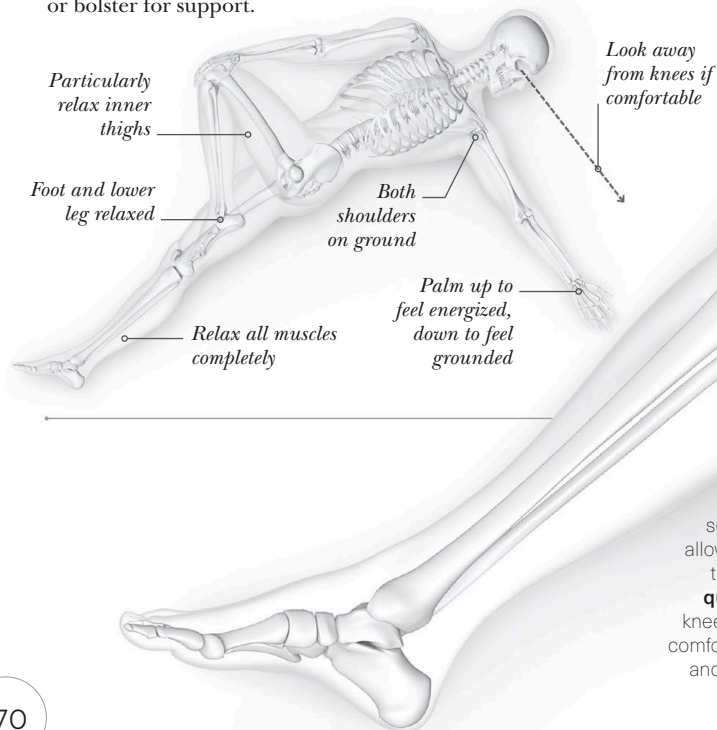
This **relaxing spinal twist** is often done at the end of a yoga class to calm your nervous system. Cultivate a sense of groundedness by releasing your body weight down into the floor. Find ease to activate the rejuvenating “rest and digest” part of your nervous system.

## THE BIG PICTURE

This pose stretches muscles along your spine, including the small muscles that rotate it. Your shoulders, glutes, and thigh muscles are also stretching, though elsewhere in your body your muscles should be as relaxed as possible.

### ALIGNMENT

Release completely to gravity, feeling your bones dropping down. If your shoulders or knee can't completely release, feel free to use a blanket or bolster for support.



### Thighs

Although you may feel some sensation in your bottom thigh, allow it to be passive. On your top thigh, your **hip abductors** and **quadriceps** stretch. Allow your knee to drop down until you feel a comfortable stretch across your hip and torso into your opposite arm.

Knee  
Vastus lateralis  
Iliotibial band  
Rectus femoris  
Gluteus maximus  
Gluteus medius